

New Digital Competition Act tabled in Parliament

The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Finance has stressed the need for a new Digital Competition Act to prescribe a code of conduct for tech giants so that they do not stifle competition with their market power. It listed a set of undesirable practices observed in the digital economy, such as e-commerce platforms pushing their own private labels over third-party brands sold on the platform. They were found using customers' personal data to get ahead of the competition and bundling different products and services. So, the committee said that a code of conduct based approach was needed for digital market winners called digital market gatekeepers.

NRDC to do tech commercialisation for startups

Union Minister Dr Jitendra Singh recently stated that from January 2023 National Research Development Corporation (NRDC) is undertaking technology commercialisation for the benefit of startups. It is noteworthy that the minister presided over



a meeting with the Secretary, DSIR and other senior officials of NRDC at the CSIR Centre in New Delhi. Dr Jitendra Singh remarked that since its inception, NRDC has concluded over 5,000 licence agreements representing technologies in almost all industry sectors.

Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events		
Event, Date and Venue	Topics	Contact address for details
Embedded World March 14-16, 2023 Nuremberg, Germany	The Embedded World exhibition and conference provides a global platform and insight into the world of embedded systems, from components and modules to operating systems, hardware and software design, M2M communication, services, and various issues related to complex system design.	Website: https://www.embedded-world.de/en
Electronics For You Tech Expo March 24-25, 2023	Pune is one of India's fastest growing electronics and automotive regions. The Pune-Nasik-Mumbai triangle represents a market that's not been tapped by any major electronics event yet. Hence, Electronics For You team is taking the initiative to launch EFY Expo @ Pune. The expo is powered by MOVES—a unique conference targeting mobility, automotive, and EV sectors.	Website: https://www.electronicsexpo.com/events/electronics-for-you-tech-expo
Open Source India 2023 October 12-13, 2023 NIMHANS Convention Center, Bengaluru	Open Source For You magazine, in partnership with India's Open Source community and industry, brings various stakeholders under one roof to accelerate development and deployment of open source in India, and beyond.	Website: https://www.opensourceindia.in
India Electronics Week February 7-9, 2024 KTPO, Whitefield, Bengaluru	India's No. 1 event for creators of smart electronics solutions to discover latest techniques, best practices and technologies for developing electronics better, cheaper and faster, and meet service providers, suppliers and partners who can enable growth of your business.	Website: www.indiaelectronicsweek.com
IoTShow.in 2024 February 7-9, 2024 KTPO, Whitefield, Bengaluru	The conferences and hands-on workshops, cutting-edge talks and trainings by industry stalwarts and thought leaders will help build the skills you need to get ahead in the field.	Website: https://www.iotshow.in
Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.		

SMEV alleges misappropriation of subsidies under FAME II scheme

In a major development in the EV sector, the Society of Manufacturers of Electric Vehicles (SMEV) recently

the FAME India Phase II scheme by some EV makers. In a response to this, SMEV Secretary General Ajay Sharma said that the allegation is "invalid in the context of the issue at hand." Notably, as per the scheme, electric two-wheeler makers are required to have at least 50% localisation of components to avail of the subsidy.

REIL awards contract for 253 EV chargers for highways

Rajasthan Electronics & Instruments Ltd (REIL) has awarded a contract to supply 253 fast EV chargers to Statiq—a leading provider of EV charging services. These chargers will be deployed at four key under-construction highways connecting Agra-Lucknow, Meerut-Gangotri, Chennai-Bellary, and Mangaldai-Wakro. The company said that it will ensure an affordable, accessible, and reliable four-wheeler charging network. While this is an outright sale, Statiq will maintain the overall quality and upkeep of the equipment for the next three years.

hit out at the Central government for alleging the misappropriation of subsidies under the FAME India Phase II scheme. Union Minister Mahendra Nath Pandey told the Parliament that the ministry received complaints regarding the misappropriation of subsidies under